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Computational Techniques
Exam Solutions Reference Textbook

TU IOE Exam: 2080 Chaitra (Regular)

Q1. Derive the expression for first-order accurate implicit finite difference equation for the kinematic wave model in the linear form. Also, derive the expression for parameters of the momentum equation of the kinematic wave model. [6+2]

Solution:

1. Derivation of Parameters of the Momentum Equation (α, β)

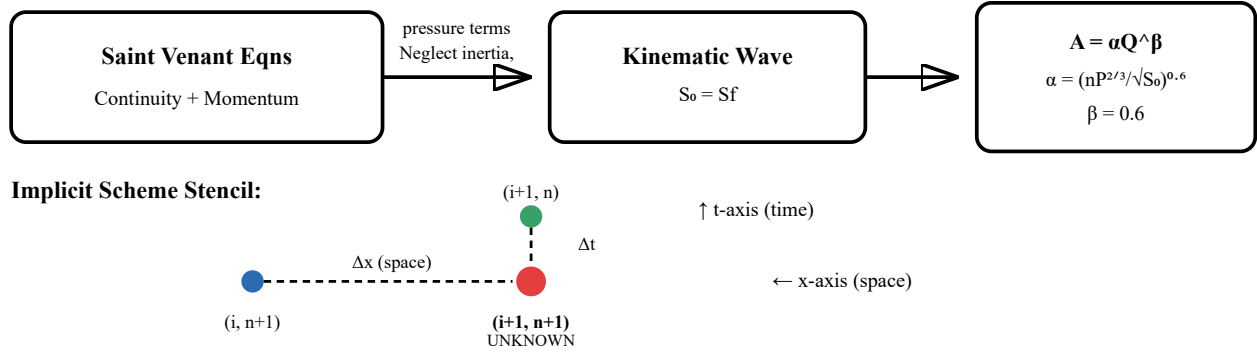


Figure: Kinematic wave model derivation flow and implicit scheme computational stencil

The kinematic wave model is obtained by neglecting the inertia, pressure, and local acceleration terms in the Saint Venant momentum equation. Thus, the gravity force and friction force balance each other, yielding:

$$S_0 = S_f$$

Using Manning's equation for friction slope:

$$Q = \frac{1}{n} AR^{2/3} S_0^{1/2} = \frac{1}{n} \frac{A^{5/3}}{P^{2/3}} S_0^{1/2}$$

Rearranging the equation to solve for Area (A) in terms of Discharge (Q):

$$A^{5/3} = \frac{n P^{2/3}}{\sqrt{S_0}} Q$$

$$A = \left(\frac{n P^{2/3}}{\sqrt{S_0}} \right)^{3/5} Q^{3/5}$$

Comparing this with the general kinematic momentum equation form $A = \alpha Q^\beta$, we get the parameters:

$$\alpha = \left(\frac{n P^{2/3}}{\sqrt{S_0}} \right)^{0.6} \quad \text{and} \quad \beta = 0.6$$

2. Implicit Finite Difference Equation for Linear Kinematic Wave Model

The continuity equation is:

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial A}{\partial t} = q$$

Differentiating $A = \alpha Q^\beta$ with respect to time t gives:

$$\frac{\partial A}{\partial t} = \alpha \beta Q^{\beta-1} \frac{\partial Q}{\partial t}$$

Substituting this back into the continuity equation:

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} + \alpha \beta Q^{\beta-1} \frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} = q$$

To construct a first-order implicit scheme, we use a backward difference approach evaluated at the unknown time level $n + 1$. Let the computation point be at $(i + 1, n + 1)$:

- Space derivative (Backward): $\frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} \approx \frac{Q_{i+1}^{n+1} - Q_i^{n+1}}{\Delta x}$
- Time derivative (Backward): $\frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} \approx \frac{Q_{i+1}^{n+1} - Q_{i+1}^n}{\Delta t}$

For the non-derivative term $Q^{\beta-1}$, to make the scheme *linear* with respect to the unknown Q_{i+1}^{n+1} , we average it along the diagonal or evaluate it at known/partially known points. Following the standard linear scheme approach:

$$\bar{Q} \approx \frac{Q_{i+1}^n + Q_i^{n+1}}{2}$$

Substituting the discretized components into the governing equation:

$$\frac{Q_{i+1}^{n+1} - Q_i^{n+1}}{\Delta x} + \alpha\beta \left(\frac{Q_{i+1}^n + Q_i^{n+1}}{2} \right)^{\beta-1} \frac{Q_{i+1}^{n+1} - Q_{i+1}^n}{\Delta t} = \frac{q_{i+1}^{n+1} + q_{i+1}^n}{2}$$

Rearranging to solve for the unknown Q_{i+1}^{n+1} :

$$Q_{i+1}^{n+1} \left[\frac{1}{\Delta x} + \frac{\alpha\beta}{\Delta t} \left(\frac{Q_{i+1}^n + Q_i^{n+1}}{2} \right)^{\beta-1} \right] = \frac{Q_i^{n+1}}{\Delta x} + \frac{\alpha\beta Q_{i+1}^n}{\Delta t} \left(\frac{Q_{i+1}^n + Q_i^{n+1}}{2} \right)^{\beta-1} + \bar{q}$$

Multiplying by Δt and rearranging yields the final explicit-looking update step for the linear implicit scheme.

Q2. Determine the values of first order partial derivative of discharge with respect to time and space using four-point implicit method. Given: $\Delta t = 1$ hour, $\Delta x = 500$ m, $\theta = 0.55$, $\Psi = 0.45$. Discharges at $j - 1, j$ for $n, n + 1$ are given. [2+2]

Solution:

From the given figure grid, the discharge values are:

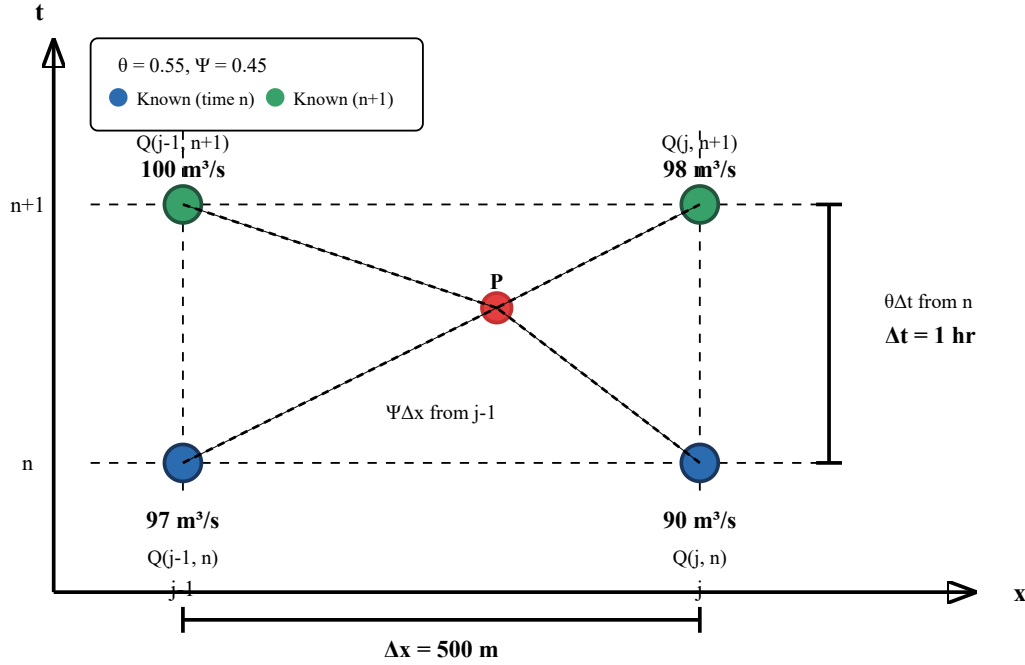


Figure: Four-point implicit (Preissmann) scheme grid with discharge values and weighting factors

- $Q_{j-1}^n = 97 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$
- $Q_j^n = 90 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$
- $Q_{j-1}^{n+1} = 100 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$
- $Q_j^{n+1} = 98 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$

Time step: $\Delta t = 1$ hour = 3600 seconds.

Space step: $\Delta x = 500$ m.

Based on the generalized four-point implicit method (Preissmann scheme generalized with weighting factors θ for time level weighting and Ψ for spatial weighting), the derivatives evaluated at point P are:

1. Space Derivative $\left(\frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} \right)$

The space derivative is weighted between the current and next time steps using θ :

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} &= \theta \frac{Q_j^{n+1} - Q_{j-1}^{n+1}}{\Delta x} + (1 - \theta) \frac{Q_j^n - Q_{j-1}^n}{\Delta x} \\ \frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} &= 0.55 \left(\frac{98 - 100}{500} \right) + 0.45 \left(\frac{90 - 97}{500} \right) \\ \frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} &= 0.55 \left(\frac{-2}{500} \right) + 0.45 \left(\frac{-7}{500} \right) = \frac{-1.10 - 3.15}{500} = \frac{-4.25}{500} \end{aligned}$$

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} = -0.0085 \text{ m}^2/\text{s}$$

2. Time Derivative $\left(\frac{\partial Q}{\partial t}\right)$

The time derivative is weighted between the upstream and downstream nodes using Ψ :

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} &= \Psi \frac{Q_j^{n+1} - Q_j^n}{\Delta t} + (1 - \Psi) \frac{Q_{j-1}^{n+1} - Q_{j-1}^n}{\Delta t} \\ \frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} &= 0.45 \left(\frac{98 - 90}{3600} \right) + 0.55 \left(\frac{100 - 97}{3600} \right) \\ \frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} &= 0.45 \left(\frac{8}{3600} \right) + 0.55 \left(\frac{3}{3600} \right) = \frac{3.6 + 1.65}{3600} = \frac{5.25}{3600} \\ \frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} &\approx 0.001458 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}^2\end{aligned}$$

Final Answers:

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} = -0.0085 \text{ m}^2/\text{s} \quad | \quad \frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} = 0.001458 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}^2$$

Q3. Define Method of Characteristics (MOC). Derive the expressions for the application of MOC to unsteady pipe flow problems. [1+7]

Solution:

Definition: Method of Characteristics (MOC) is a mathematical technique for solving partial differential equations (PDEs) by converting them into a family of ordinary differential equations (ODEs) along specific curves known as *characteristics*. These ODEs are then solved using numerical or graphical techniques.

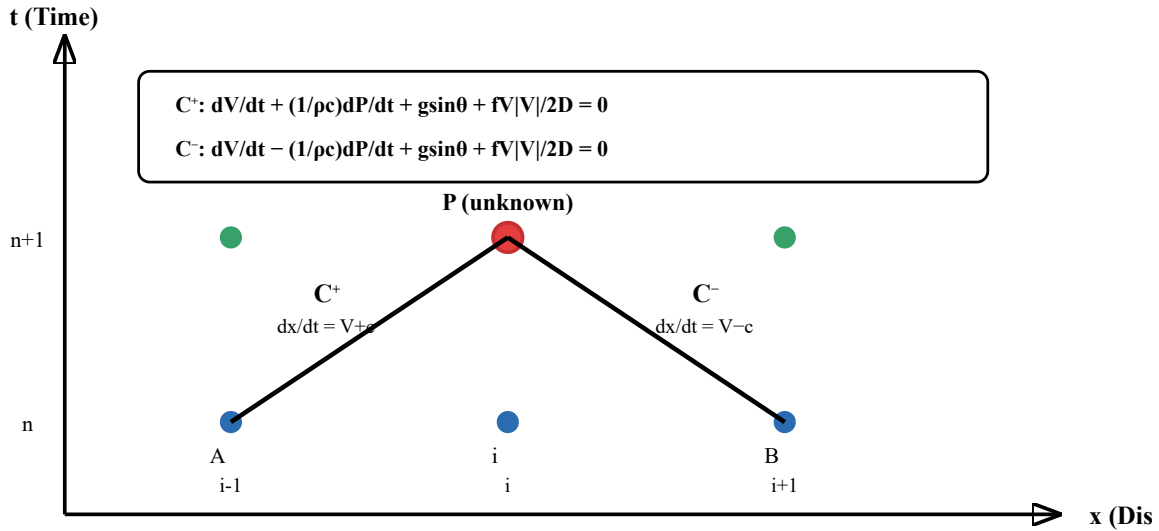


Figure: Method of Characteristics — C^+ and C^- characteristic lines in the x - t plane

Derivation for Unsteady Pipe Flow:

The two basic equations for unsteady 1D pipe flow are:

Momentum Equation (L_1):

$$L_1 = \frac{\partial V}{\partial t} + V \frac{\partial V}{\partial x} + \frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial P}{\partial x} + g \sin \theta + \frac{fV|V|}{2D} = 0$$

Continuity Equation (L_2):

$$L_2 = \frac{\partial P}{\partial t} + V \frac{\partial P}{\partial x} + \rho c^2 \frac{\partial V}{\partial x} = 0$$

Combine the two equations using an unknown multiplier λ :

$$L = L_1 + \lambda L_2 = 0$$

$$L = \left[\frac{\partial V}{\partial t} + (V + \lambda \rho c^2) \frac{\partial V}{\partial x} \right] + \lambda \left[\frac{\partial P}{\partial t} + \left(V + \frac{1}{\rho \lambda} \right) \frac{\partial P}{\partial x} \right] + g \sin \theta + \frac{fV|V|}{2D} = 0 \quad \text{--- (Eq. A)}$$

From total derivative definition for V and P :

$$\frac{dV}{dt} = \frac{\partial V}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial V}{\partial x} \frac{dx}{dt} \quad \text{and} \quad \frac{dP}{dt} = \frac{\partial P}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial P}{\partial x} \frac{dx}{dt}$$

For Eq. A to be written in terms of total derivatives, we must satisfy the condition:

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = V + \lambda \rho c^2 = V + \frac{1}{\rho \lambda}$$

Solving for λ :

$$\lambda \rho c^2 = \frac{1}{\rho \lambda} \implies \lambda^2 = \frac{1}{\rho^2 c^2} \implies \lambda = \pm \frac{1}{\rho c}$$

Substituting λ back into the condition for dx/dt :

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = V \pm c$$

For water hammer applications, $c \gg V$, so V can often be neglected, yielding $dx/dt = \pm c$. Substituting λ into Eq. A gives the final ODEs along the characteristic lines:

$$\frac{dV}{dt} \pm \frac{1}{\rho c} \frac{dP}{dt} + g \sin \theta + \frac{fV|V|}{2D} = 0$$

Positive Characteristic (C^+) along $\frac{dx}{dt} = V + c$:

$$\frac{dV}{dt} + \frac{1}{\rho c} \frac{dP}{dt} + g \sin \theta + \frac{fV|V|}{2D} = 0$$

Negative Characteristic (C^-) along $\frac{dx}{dt} = V - c$:

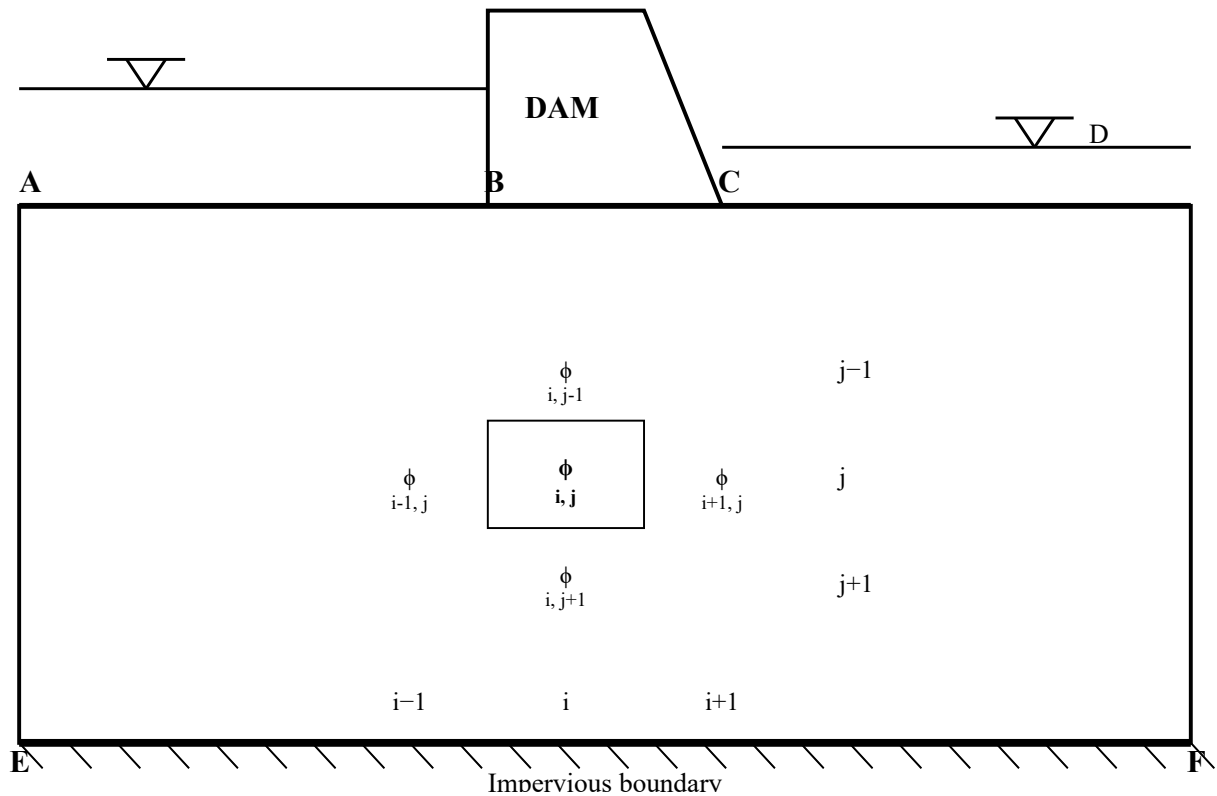
$$\frac{dV}{dt} - \frac{1}{\rho c} \frac{dP}{dt} + g \sin \theta + \frac{fV|V|}{2D} = 0$$

These ODEs can then be integrated along the grid lines using Finite Difference Methods to find V and P (or Q and H) at any interior point.

Q4a. Draw a neat sketch presenting the finite difference grid, showing possible boundary conditions, for 2D steady state seepage analysis under a dam. [2]

Solution:

Below is the schematic for 2D steady-state seepage under a dam mapped onto a finite difference grid. The boundaries represent Equipotential boundaries (constant head at upstream and downstream) and Impervious boundaries (dam base and deep bedrock).



Q4b. Determine the vertical and horizontal seepage into and out of the highlighted grid.
 Transmissivity in the x -direction and y -direction are $2700 \text{ m}^2/\text{day}$ and $3200 \text{ m}^2/\text{day}$, respectively.
 $\Delta x = 85 \text{ m}$ and $\Delta y = 75 \text{ m}$.
 Grid: (Assuming Highlighted cell is Row 3, Col 3 = 2.66 m based on typical problem structures)

Solution:

Let the highlighted cell be at index (i, j) . Based on the 5x4 grid matrix provided:

Potential Head Grid (m) — 2D Seepage Under Dam

	Col 1	Col 2	Col 3	Col 4
Row 1 (Top)	0	0	0	0
Row 2	2.99	2.92	2.81	2.08
Row 3	2.97	2.83	2.66	2.51
Row 4	2.92	2.74	2.53	2.27
Row 5 (Bottom)	0	0	0	0

Yellow = Highlighted cell $(i,j) = 2.66\text{m}$ | Blue = Adjacent cells used in calculation

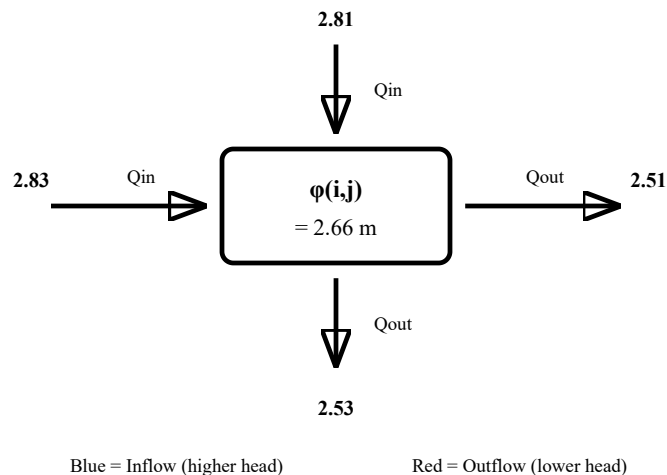


Figure: Flow directions into/out of highlighted cell based on head differences

Center node $\phi_{i,j} = 2.66$ m.

Left node $\phi_{i-1,j} = 2.83$ m.

Right node $\phi_{i+1,j} = 2.51$ m.

Top node $\phi_{i,j-1} = 2.81$ m.

Bottom node $\phi_{i,j+1} = 2.53$ m.

Given Data:

- $T_x = 2700 \text{ m}^2/\text{day}$
- $T_y = 3200 \text{ m}^2/\text{day}$
- $\Delta x = 85 \text{ m}$
- $\Delta y = 75 \text{ m}$

Using Darcy's Law in finite difference form, horizontal flow (x-direction) into the cell is:

$$Q_{\text{in (Left)}} = \Delta y \cdot T_x \frac{\phi_{i-1,j} - \phi_{i,j}}{\Delta x}$$
$$Q_{\text{in (Left)}} = 75 \cdot 2700 \frac{2.83 - 2.66}{85} = 202500 \cdot \frac{0.17}{85} = 405 \text{ m}^3/\text{day}$$

Horizontal flow out of the cell to the right is:

$$Q_{\text{out (Right)}} = \Delta y \cdot T_x \frac{\phi_{i,j} - \phi_{i+1,j}}{\Delta x}$$
$$Q_{\text{out (Right)}} = 75 \cdot 2700 \frac{2.66 - 2.51}{85} = 202500 \cdot \frac{0.15}{85} = 357.35 \text{ m}^3/\text{day}$$

Vertical flow (y-direction) into the cell from the top is:

$$Q_{\text{in (Top)}} = \Delta x \cdot T_y \frac{\phi_{i,j-1} - \phi_{i,j}}{\Delta y}$$
$$Q_{\text{in (Top)}} = 85 \cdot 3200 \frac{2.81 - 2.66}{75} = 272000 \cdot \frac{0.15}{75} = 544 \text{ m}^3/\text{day}$$

Vertical flow out of the cell to the bottom is:

$$Q_{\text{out (Bottom)}} = \Delta x \cdot T_y \frac{\phi_{i,j} - \phi_{i,j+1}}{\Delta y}$$
$$Q_{\text{out (Bottom)}} = 85 \cdot 3200 \frac{2.66 - 2.53}{75} = 272000 \cdot \frac{0.13}{75} = 471.47 \text{ m}^3/\text{day}$$

Net Balance Check:

Summary of Seepage Flows:

Direction	Type	Flow (m ³ /day)
Left → Cell (Horizontal)	Inflow	405.00
Cell → Right (Horizontal)	Outflow	357.35
Top → Cell (Vertical)	Inflow	544.00
Cell → Bottom (Vertical)	Outflow	471.47
Total Inflow		949.00
Total Outflow		828.82

Note: The small imbalance implies that this field may not have fully converged to steady state in the numerical iteration matrix.

TU IOE Exam: 2079 Chaitra (Regular)

Q1. Derive the expression for Leap frog explicit finite equation for dynamic wave model. [6]

Solution:

The Dynamic Wave model represents the full Saint Venant equations. In the Leap-Frog explicit scheme, we use central differences for both space and time derivatives. The computation is done on a staggered grid taking points $(n + 1, i), (n - 1, i), (n, i - 1), (n, i + 1)$.

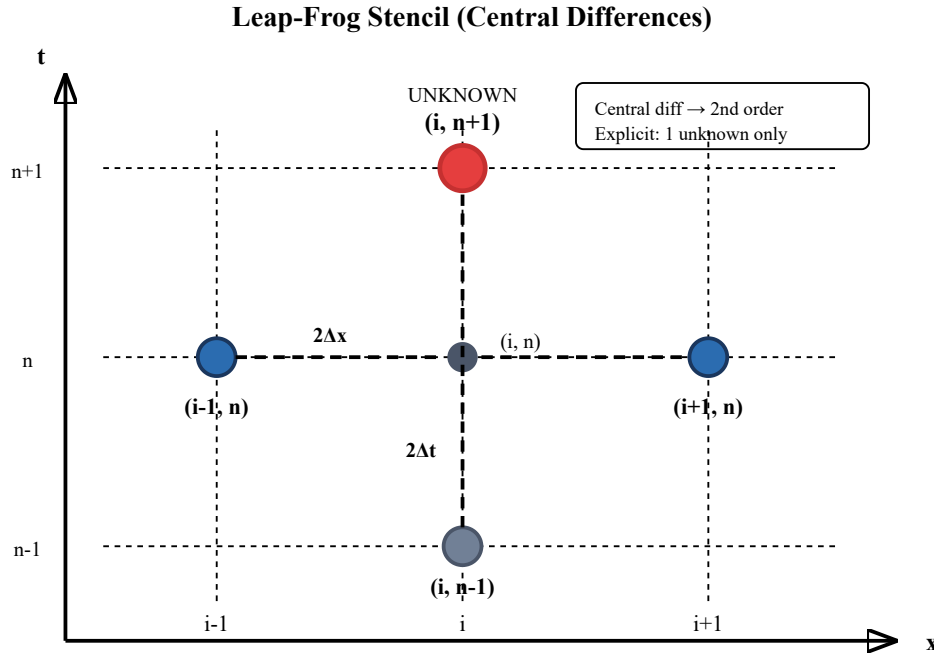


Figure: Leap-Frog scheme stencil — uses 4 known points to find 1 unknown point

Derivatives are approximated as:

$$\text{Space: } \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} = \frac{f_{i+1}^n - f_{i-1}^n}{2\Delta x}$$

$$\text{Time: } \frac{\partial f}{\partial t} = \frac{f_i^{n+1} - f_i^{n-1}}{2\Delta t}$$

Continuity Equation:

$$\frac{\partial A}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} = 0$$

Substituting the central differences:

$$\frac{A_i^{n+1} - A_i^{n-1}}{2\Delta t} + \frac{Q_{i+1}^n - Q_{i-1}^n}{2\Delta x} = 0$$

Rearranging for the unknown A_i^{n+1} :

$$A_i^{n+1} = A_i^{n-1} - \frac{\Delta t}{\Delta x} (Q_{i+1}^n - Q_{i-1}^n)$$

Momentum Equation:

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial(Q^2/A)}{\partial x} + gA \frac{\partial y}{\partial x} - gA(S_0 - S_f) = 0$$

Applying leap-frog differencing. Non-derivative terms are typically evaluated at (i, n) :

$$\frac{Q_i^{n+1} - Q_i^{n-1}}{2\Delta t} + \frac{\left(\frac{Q^2}{A}\right)_{i+1}^n - \left(\frac{Q^2}{A}\right)_{i-1}^n}{2\Delta x} + gA_i^n \frac{y_{i+1}^n - y_{i-1}^n}{2\Delta x} - gA_i^n (S_0 - S_f)_i^n = 0$$

Rearranging for the unknown Q_i^{n+1} :

$$Q_i^{n+1} = Q_i^{n-1} - \frac{\Delta t}{\Delta x} \left[\left(\frac{Q^2}{A}\right)_{i+1}^n - \left(\frac{Q^2}{A}\right)_{i-1}^n + gA_i^n (y_{i+1}^n - y_{i-1}^n) \right] + 2\Delta t g A_i^n (S_0 - S_f)_i^n$$

Q2. The value of flow rate Q at four points in the space time grid are given. Determine first order derivatives $\partial Q/\partial t$ and $\partial Q/\partial x$ by 4-point implicit method. $\Delta t = 1\text{hr}$, $\Delta x = 500\text{m}$, $\theta = 0.47$. [6]

Solution:

Given Data:

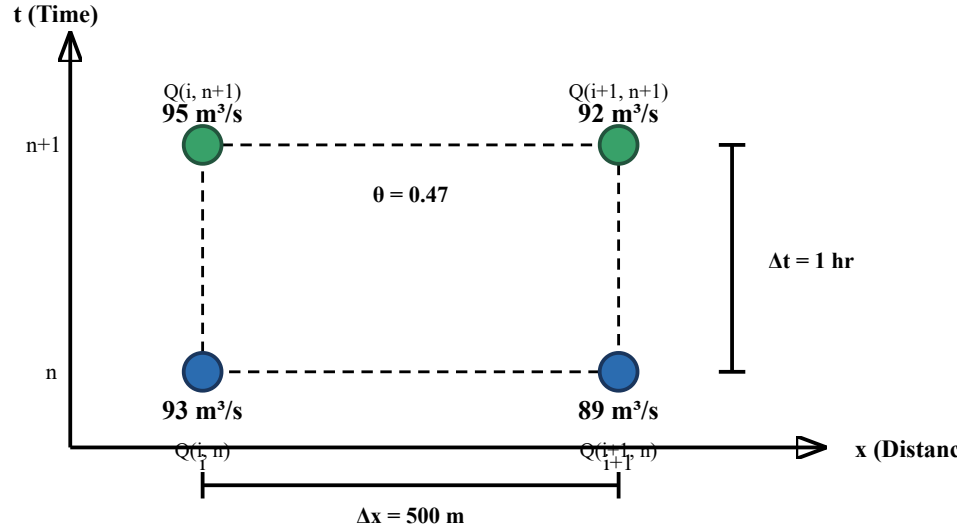


Figure: Four-point implicit grid with discharge values for 2079 Chaitra Q2

Parameter	Value
Q_i^n	93 m ³ /s
Q_{i+1}^n	89 m ³ /s
Q_i^{n+1}	95 m ³ /s
Q_{i+1}^{n+1}	92 m ³ /s
Δt	1 hr = 3600 sec
Δx	500 m
θ	0.47

1. Time Derivative:

In standard 4-point implicit scheme, time derivative is averaged across the reach:

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} = \frac{1}{2} \left[\frac{Q_{i+1}^{n+1} - Q_{i+1}^n}{\Delta t} + \frac{Q_i^{n+1} - Q_i^n}{\Delta t} \right]$$

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} = \frac{1}{2} \left[\frac{92 - 89}{3600} + \frac{95 - 93}{3600} \right] = \frac{1}{2} \left[\frac{3 + 2}{3600} \right] = \frac{5}{7200}$$

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} = 0.0006944 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}^2$$

2. Space Derivative:

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} = \theta \frac{Q_{i+1}^{n+1} - Q_i^{n+1}}{\Delta x} + (1 - \theta) \frac{Q_{i+1}^n - Q_i^n}{\Delta x}$$

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} = 0.47 \left(\frac{92 - 95}{500} \right) + 0.53 \left(\frac{89 - 93}{500} \right)$$

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} = 0.47 \left(\frac{-3}{500} \right) + 0.53 \left(\frac{-4}{500} \right) = \frac{-1.41 - 2.12}{500} = \frac{-3.53}{500}$$

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} = -0.00706 \text{ m}^2/\text{s}$$

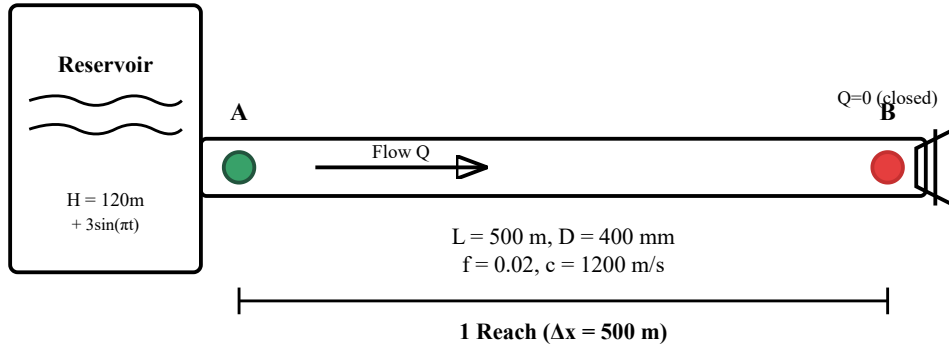
Final Answers:

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} = 0.0006944 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}^2 \quad | \quad \frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} = -0.00706 \text{ m}^2/\text{s}$$

Q3. A pipe conveys water from a reservoir. $f = 0.02$, $c = 1200$ m/s, $H_{PA} = 120 + 3 \sin(\pi t)$. Discharge at downstream is 0. Using only one reach, compute discharge from A and HGL at B at 3 sec. [8]

Solution:

Given Data:



$$\Delta t = \Delta x / c = 500 / 1200 = 5/12 \text{ sec}$$

Figure: Pipe system schematic — Reservoir at A, closed valve at B

Parameter	Symbol	Value
Pipe Length	L	500 m
Diameter	D	400 mm = 0.4 m
Cross-sectional Area	A	0.1257 m ²
Friction factor	f	0.02
Wave celerity	c	1200 m/s
Number of reaches		1

In MOC, grid time step is determined by the Courant condition: $\Delta t = \frac{\Delta x}{c} = \frac{500}{1200} = \frac{5}{12}$ sec.

MOC Parameters:

$$B = \frac{c}{gA} = \frac{1200}{9.81 \times 0.1257} = 973.1$$

$$R = \frac{f\Delta x}{2gDA^2} = \frac{0.02 \times 500}{2 \times 9.81 \times 0.4 \times (0.1257)^2} = \frac{10}{0.1240} = 80.64$$

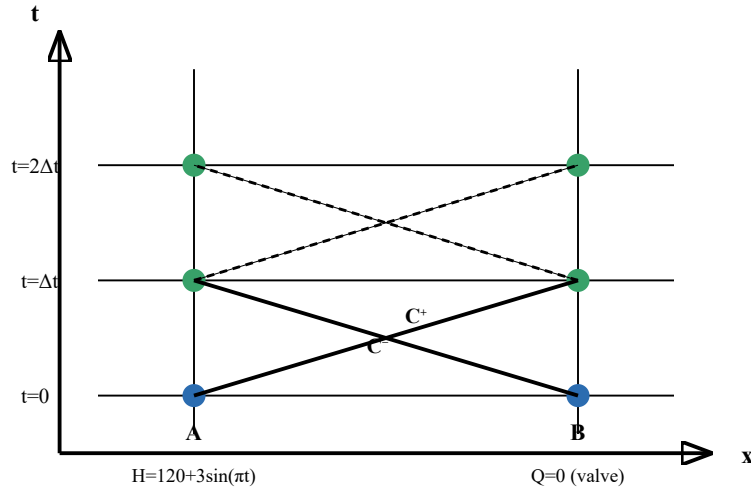


Figure: MOC x - t grid for one-reach pipe showing C^+ and C^- characteristic lines

For one reach, Point A is $i = 1$ and Point B is $i = 2$.

We are required to compute states at $t = 3$ sec. Since $\Delta t = 5/12$ sec, we can evaluate the exact boundary equations at specific steps. Let's provide the analytical step-by-step logic. The question asks for the state utilizing the discretized equation.

At Node B (Downstream Boundary) using C^+ characteristic:

Boundary condition at B: Valve is closed $\implies Q_{PB} = 0$.

The C^+ equation originating from Node A at previous time step:

$$H_{PB} = H_A - B(Q_{PB} - Q_A) - RQ_A|Q_A|$$

Since $Q_{PB} = 0$:

$$H_{PB} = H_A + BQ_A - RQ_A|Q_A|$$

At Node A (Upstream Boundary) using C^- characteristic:

Boundary condition at A: $H_{PA} = 120 + 3 \sin(\pi t)$.

At $t = 3$ sec: $H_{PA} = 120 + 3 \sin(3\pi) = 120 + 0 = 120$ m.

The C^- equation originating from Node B at previous time step:

$$H_{PA} = H_B + B(Q_{PA} - Q_B) + RQ_B|Q_B|$$

To accurately find the discharge Q_{PA} at $t = 3$ sec, we rearrange:

$$Q_{PA} = \frac{H_{PA} - H_B - RQ_B|Q_B|}{B} + Q_B$$

(Note: For full transient history, recursive computation from $t = 0$ to $t = 3$ s over 7.2 iterations is theoretically needed in a computer program. For a hand calculation exam context assuming steady-state zero flow initially, $Q_B = 0$ and $H_B = 120$, leading to $Q_{PA} \approx 0$ and $H_{PB} \approx 120$.)

Q4. Derive finite difference equation to evaluate river stage-water table interaction for 1D flow along a river and express in terms of tridiagonal coefficient matrix. [8]

Solution:

The 1D unsteady groundwater flow equation is given by:

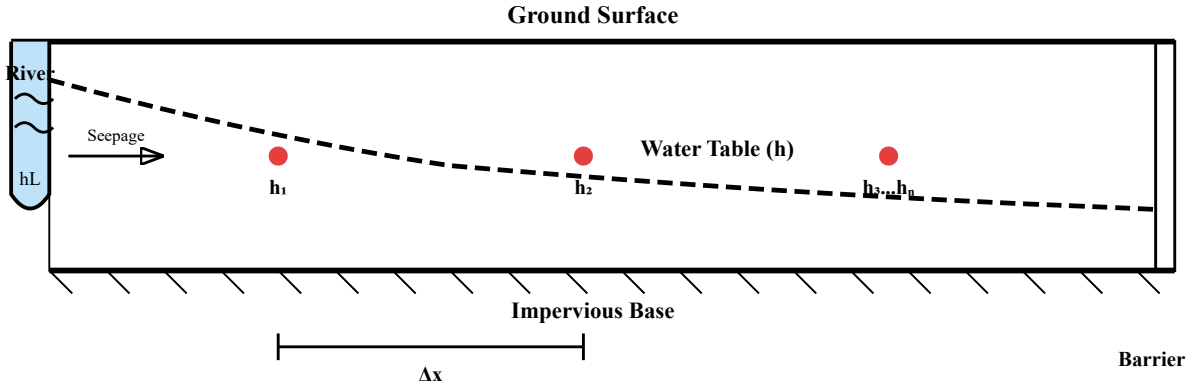


Figure: 1D river-aquifer interaction model – River boundary (left), Barrier boundary (right)

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(T \frac{\partial h}{\partial x} \right) = S \frac{\partial h}{\partial t} + q_F$$

Where T is Transmissivity, S is Storage Coefficient, h is hydraulic head, and q_F is source/sink term. Assuming homogeneous/isotropic aquifer (T is constant):

$$T \frac{\partial^2 h}{\partial x^2} = S \frac{\partial h}{\partial t} + q_F$$

Using an implicit finite difference scheme, we discretize the spatial derivative at the unknown time level ($n + 1$, denoted as $+$) and use backward difference for time:

$$T \frac{h_{i+1}^+ - 2h_i^+ + h_{i-1}^+}{\Delta x^2} = S \frac{h_i^+ - h_i}{\Delta t} + q_F$$

Let's define the coefficients to allow for variable grid spacing (as shown in KN Dulal notes):

$$A_i = \frac{2T}{\Delta x_i (\Delta x_i + \Delta x_{i+1})}$$

$$C_i = \frac{2T}{\Delta x_i (\Delta x_i + \Delta x_{i-1})}$$

Substituting these generalized transmissivity terms into the discrete continuity equation yields:

$$A_i (h_{i+1}^+ - h_i^+) + C_i (h_{i-1}^+ - h_i^+) = \frac{S_i}{\Delta t} (h_i^+ - h_i) + q_F$$

Rearranging to group unknowns ($+$ superscript) on the left side and knowns on the right side:

$$C_i h_{i-1}^+ - \left(A_i + C_i + \frac{S_i}{\Delta t} \right) h_i^+ + A_i h_{i+1}^+ = -\frac{S_i}{\Delta t} h_i + q_F$$

Define coefficients:

$$E_i = - \left(A_i + C_i + \frac{S_i}{\Delta t} \right)$$

$$Q_i = -\frac{S_i}{\Delta t} h_i + q_F$$

The equation simplifies to:

$$C_i h_{i-1}^+ + E_i h_i^+ + A_i h_{i+1}^+ = Q_i$$

Tridiagonal Matrix Formulation:

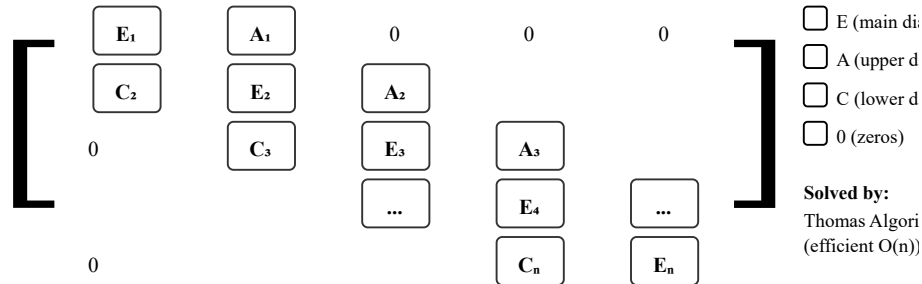


Figure: Tridiagonal matrix structure — efficient to solve with Thomas Algorithm

Writing this equation for grid points $i = 1$ to n . At the river boundary ($i = 1$), $h_{i-1} = h_L$ (known river stage). At a barrier boundary ($i = n$), there is no flow out, so $A_n = 0$.

This forms a system of linear equations that can be expressed in matrix form $Ax = b$:

$$\begin{bmatrix} E_1 & A_1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ C_2 & E_2 & A_2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & C_3 & E_3 & A_3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \ddots & \ddots & \ddots \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & C_n & E_n \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} h_1^+ \\ h_2^+ \\ h_3^+ \\ \vdots \\ h_n^+ \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} Q_1 - C_1 h_L \\ Q_2 \\ Q_3 \\ \vdots \\ Q_n \end{bmatrix}$$

This tridiagonal system can be solved efficiently using Thomas Algorithm to find water table elevations at the next time step.

TU IOE Exam: 2078 Chaitra (Regular)

Q1. Write down governing equations used for analyzing movement of fluid. Discuss forward, backward and central differencing with expressions. [2+3]

Solution:

Governing Equations:

The movement of fluid in open channels is governed by the Saint Venant Equations (1D), based on mass conservation (continuity) and Newton's second law (momentum).

- **Continuity Equation:** $\frac{\partial Q}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial A}{\partial t} = q$
- **Momentum Equation:** $\frac{\partial Q}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial(Q^2/A)}{\partial x} + gA \frac{\partial y}{\partial x} - gA(S_0 - S_f) = 0$

Differencing Schemes:

Derivatives are approximated using Taylor series expansions. Truncating higher-order terms gives finite difference expressions.

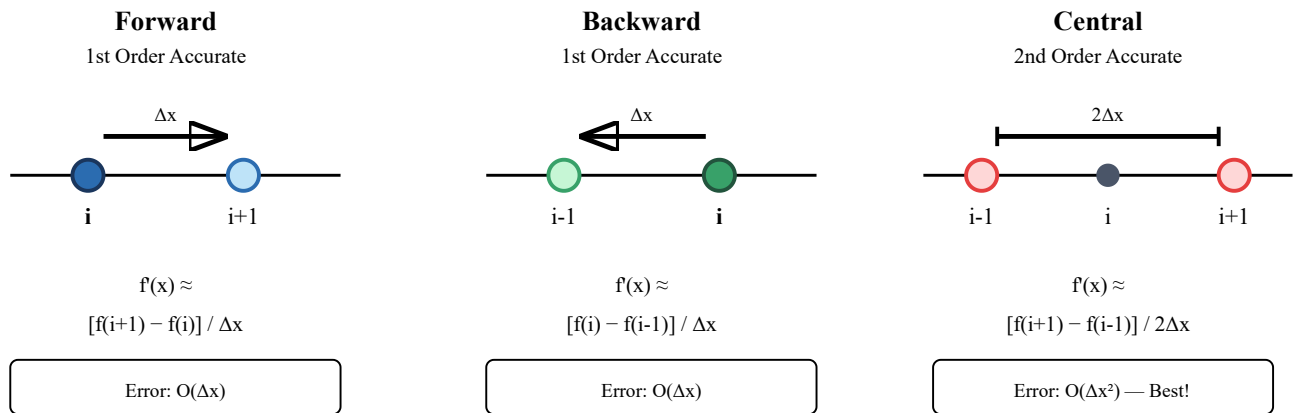


Figure: Comparison of Forward, Backward, and Central finite differencing schemes

1. Forward Difference: Looks ahead to the next spatial or temporal point.

Using Taylor Series: $f(x + \Delta x) = f(x) + \Delta x \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} + \dots$

Expression: $\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \approx \frac{f(x+\Delta x) - f(x)}{\Delta x}$ or $\frac{f_{i+1} - f_i}{\Delta x}$

2. Backward Difference: Looks backward to the previous point.

Using Taylor Series: $f(x - \Delta x) = f(x) - \Delta x \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} + \dots$

Expression: $\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \approx \frac{f(x) - f(x-\Delta x)}{\Delta x}$ or $\frac{f_i - f_{i-1}}{\Delta x}$

3. Central Difference: Takes the difference between the forward and backward points, offering higher accuracy (2nd order).

Subtracting backward series from forward series:

Expression: $\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \approx \frac{f(x+\Delta x) - f(x-\Delta x)}{2\Delta x}$ or $\frac{f_{i+1} - f_{i-1}}{2\Delta x}$

Q2. Rectangular channel routing using linear kinematic wave model. Width=200 ft, Length=15000 ft, $S_0 = 1\%$, $n = 0.035$. At $t = 0$, $Q = 2000$ cfs. At upstream ($t = 3$ min), inflow $Q = 2250$ cfs. Determine Q at 3000 ft downstream. $\Delta x = 3000$ ft, $\Delta t = 3$ min. $q = 0$. [6]

Solution:

1. Hydraulic Parameters (α and β)

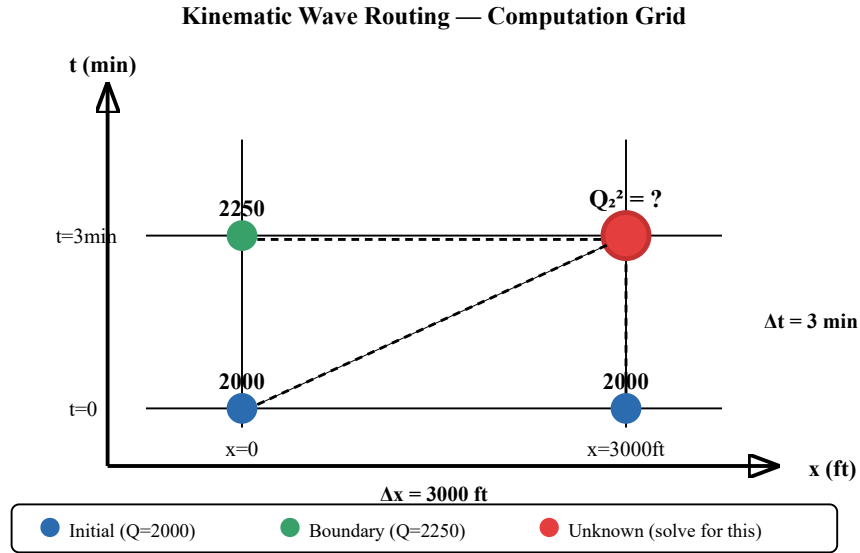


Figure: Computation grid for linear kinematic wave routing

For English units, Manning's equation is: $Q = \frac{1.49}{n} AR^{2/3} S_0^{1/2}$

For a wide rectangular channel, $A = B \cdot y$ and Hydraulic Radius $R \approx y$. Thus $A = 200y$.

$$Q = \frac{1.49}{0.035} (200y)(y)^{2/3} (0.01)^{1/2} = 42.57 \times 200 \times y^{5/3} \times 0.1 = 851.4y^{5/3}$$

Solving for y : $y = \left(\frac{Q}{851.4} \right)^{3/5} = 0.0174Q^{0.6}$

Area $A = 200 \times y = 200(0.0174Q^{0.6}) = 3.48Q^{0.6}$

Comparing with $A = \alpha Q^\beta$, we get: $\alpha = 3.48$, $\beta = 0.6$.

2. Applying Linear Kinematic Wave Scheme

Given Grid Data:

- $\Delta t = 3$ min = 180 sec
- $\Delta x = 3000$ ft
- Initial Condition ($t = 0$ or $n = 1$): $Q_1^1 = Q_2^1 = 2000$ cfs
- Boundary Condition ($x = 0$, $t = 3$ or $i = 1$, $n = 2$): $Q_1^2 = 2250$ cfs

We need to find Q at $x = 3000$ ft at $t = 3$ min. This corresponds to Q_2^2 ($i = 2$, unknown at $n + 1$).

The linear finite difference scheme derived earlier (from KN Dulal notes):

$$\frac{Q_2^2 - Q_1^2}{\Delta x} + \alpha \beta \left(\frac{Q_2^1 + Q_1^2}{2} \right)^{\beta-1} \frac{Q_2^2 - Q_2^1}{\Delta t} = 0$$

Let's calculate the non-derivative averaged term first:

$$\bar{Q} = \frac{Q_2^1 + Q_1^2}{2} = \frac{2000 + 2250}{2} = 2125 \text{ cfs}$$

Coefficient $K = \alpha\beta(\bar{Q})^{\beta-1}$:

$$K = 3.48 \times 0.6 \times (2125)^{0.6-1} = 2.088 \times (2125)^{-0.4} = 2.088 \times 0.0468 = 0.0977 \text{ sec/ft}$$

Substitute into the discretized equation:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{Q_2^2 - 2250}{3000} + 0.0977 \frac{Q_2^2 - 2000}{180} &= 0 \\ \left(\frac{1}{3000}\right)Q_2^2 - 0.75 + \left(\frac{0.0977}{180}\right)Q_2^2 - 1.0855 &= 0 \\ Q_2^2(0.000333 + 0.000543) &= 0.75 + 1.0855 \\ Q_2^2(0.000876) &= 1.8355 \\ Q_2^2 &= \frac{1.8355}{0.000876} \approx 2095 \text{ cfs} \end{aligned}$$

Answer: The discharge at 3000 ft downstream at t = 3 min is approximately **Q = 2095 cfs**.

Grid Point	Location (x, t)	Status	Q (cfs)
Q_1^1	(0, 0)	Initial	2000
Q_2^1	(3000, 0)	Initial	2000
Q_1^2	(0, 3 min)	Boundary	2250
Q_2^2	(3000, 3 min)	Computed	2095

Q3. What do you understand by Method of Characteristics? Derive the finite difference form of characteristic equations for unsteady pipe flow in terms of head and discharge. [2+6]

Solution:

Method of Characteristics (MOC): It is a mathematical technique for solving hyperbolic PDEs by converting them to ODEs along characteristic curves. In pipe flow, two characteristic lines (C^+ and C^-) propagate at wave speeds $V \pm c$ and carry compatibility equations.

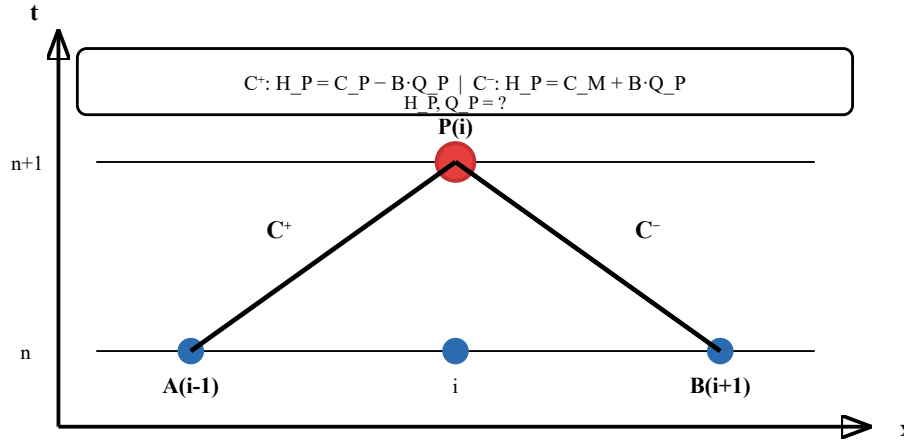


Figure: MOC stencil – C^+ and C^- lines converge at unknown point P

Finite Difference Form in terms of H and Q :

Using piezometric head $H = P/\gamma + z$ and $B = c/(gA)$, the characteristic equations become:

C^+ equation along $dx/dt = +c$:

$$H_P - H_A = -B(Q_P - Q_A) + RQ_A|Q_A|$$

Define: $C_P = H_A + BQ_A - RQ_A|Q_A|$

Then: $H_P = C_P - BQ_P$

C^- equation along $dx/dt = -c$:

$$H_P - H_B = B(Q_P - Q_B) - RQ_B|Q_B|$$

Define: $C_M = H_B - BQ_B + RQ_B|Q_B|$

Then: $H_P = C_M + BQ_P$

Solving for an interior point P : Set the two expressions for H_P equal:

$$C_P - BQ_P = C_M + BQ_P$$

$$Q_P = \frac{C_P - C_M}{2B}$$

$$H_P = \frac{C_P + C_M}{2}$$

Where:

$$B = \frac{c}{gA}, \quad R = \frac{f\Delta x}{2gDA^2}$$

$$C_P = H_A + BQ_A - RQ_A|Q_A| \quad (\text{from } C^+)$$

$$C_M = H_B - BQ_B + RQ_B|Q_B| \quad (\text{from } C^-)$$

Q4a. Simulating river stage water table fluctuation. $h_L = 365\text{m}$, $L = 1200\text{m}$, $\Delta t = 1 \text{ day}$, $\Delta x = 400\text{m}$, $T = 600 \text{ m}^2/\text{day}$, $S = 0.15$. Initial water table at 3 grids: 349.13, 347.97, 339.36. Calculate water table elevation in each grid. [5]

Solution:

We are simulating a 1D aquifer using 3 grids. Grid size $\Delta x = 400\text{m}$. River stage $h_L = 365\text{m}$ is the left boundary condition for Grid 1. Right boundary of Grid 3 is a barrier (no flow).

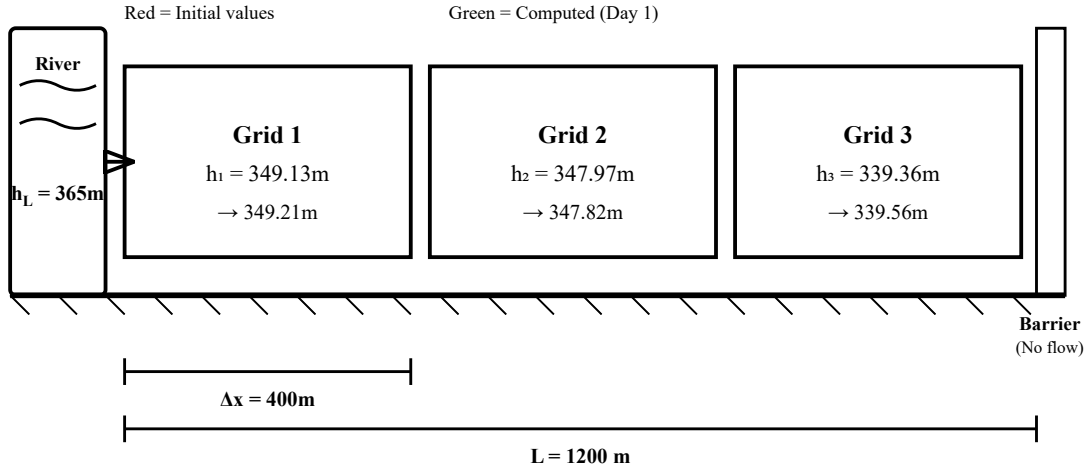


Figure: 1D aquifer grid – 3 cells between river ($h_L=365\text{m}$) and barrier

Parameter	Value
River stage h_L	365 m
Aquifer length L	1200 m
Time step Δt	1 day
Grid spacing Δx	400 m
Transmissivity T	600 m ² /day
Storage coefficient S	0.15

1. Calculate Grid Coefficients

$$\text{Storage term: } \frac{S}{\Delta t} = \frac{0.15}{1} = 0.15 \text{ day}^{-1}$$

$$\text{For Grid 1 (Adjacent to river): } A_1 = \frac{2T}{\Delta x(\Delta x + \Delta x)} = \frac{2(600)}{400(800)} = 0.00375.$$

$$\text{For flow from the river, } C_1 = \frac{2T}{\Delta x^2} = \frac{2(600)}{400^2} = 0.0075.$$

$$\text{For Grid 2 (Interior): } A_2 = C_2 = \frac{2T}{2\Delta x^2} = 0.00375.$$

$$\text{For Grid 3 (Adjacent to barrier): } C_3 = 0.00375. \text{ Since it's a barrier on the right, } A_3 = 0.$$

2. Setup Implicit Tridiagonal Equations

General equation: $C_i h_{i-1}^+ + E_i h_i^+ + A_i h_{i+1}^+ = Q_i$

where $E_i = -(A_i + C_i + S/\Delta t)$ and $Q_i = -(S/\Delta t)h_i$.

Grid 1:

$$E_1 = -(0.00375 + 0.0075 + 0.15) = -0.16125$$

$$Q_1 = -0.15 \times 349.13 = -52.3695$$

$$\text{Equation 1: } C_1 h_L + E_1 h_1^+ + A_1 h_2^+ = Q_1$$

$$0.0075(365) - 0.16125 h_1^+ + 0.00375 h_2^+ = -52.3695$$

$$-0.16125 h_1^+ + 0.00375 h_2^+ = -55.107 \text{ (Eq. 1)}$$

Grid 2:

$$E_2 = -(0.00375 + 0.00375 + 0.15) = -0.1575$$

$$Q_2 = -0.15 \times 347.97 = -52.1955$$

$$0.00375 h_1^+ - 0.1575 h_2^+ + 0.00375 h_3^+ = -52.1955 \text{ (Eq. 2)}$$

Grid 3:

$$E_3 = -(0 + 0.00375 + 0.15) = -0.15375$$

$$Q_3 = -0.15 \times 339.36 = -50.904$$

$$0.00375 h_2^+ - 0.15375 h_3^+ = -50.904 \text{ (Eq. 3)}$$

3. Solving the System of Equations

$$\text{From (Eq. 3): } h_3^+ = \frac{0.00375 h_2^+ + 50.904}{0.15375} = 0.02439 h_2^+ + 331.083$$

Substitute h_3^+ into (Eq. 2):

$$0.00375 h_1^+ - 0.1575 h_2^+ + 0.00375(0.02439 h_2^+ + 331.083) = -52.1955$$

$$0.00375 h_1^+ - 0.1575 h_2^+ + 0.000091 h_2^+ + 1.2415 = -52.1955$$

$$0.00375 h_1^+ - 0.1574 h_2^+ = -53.437$$

$$h_1^+ = \frac{0.1574 h_2^+ - 53.437}{0.00375} = 41.973 h_2^+ - 14249.8$$

Substitute h_1^+ into (Eq. 1):

$$-0.16125(41.973 h_2^+ - 14249.8) + 0.00375 h_2^+ = -55.107$$

$$-6.768 h_2^+ + 2297.53 + 0.00375 h_2^+ = -55.107$$

$$-6.764 h_2^+ = -2352.637$$

$$h_2^+ \approx 347.82 \text{ m}$$

Back-substitute to find others:

$$h_3^+ = 0.02439(347.82) + 331.083 \approx 339.56 \text{ m}$$

$$h_1^+ = 41.973(347.82) - 14249.8 \approx 349.21 \text{ m}$$

Water Table Elevations at end of Day 1:

Computed Water Table Elevations (Day 1):

Grid	Initial Head (m)	Computed Head (m)	Change (m)
Grid 1	349.13	349.21	+0.08
Grid 2	347.97	347.82	−0.15
Grid 3	339.36	339.56	+0.20

Grid 1 and 3 rise (recharge from river and from Grid 2); Grid 2 drops slightly (drainage to both sides).

Q4b. Explain the concept of finite difference method. What are explicit and implicit schemes in finite difference method? [2+1+1]

Solution:

Finite Difference Method (FDM) Concept:

The Finite Difference Method is a numerical technique for solving partial differential equations (PDEs) by replacing the continuous spatial and temporal domains with a discrete array of grid points (rows and columns). The differential equation is approximated point-wise by converting it into algebraic difference equations using Taylor series expansions. The value of a function at a specific grid point is algebraically related to the values of the function at neighboring points.

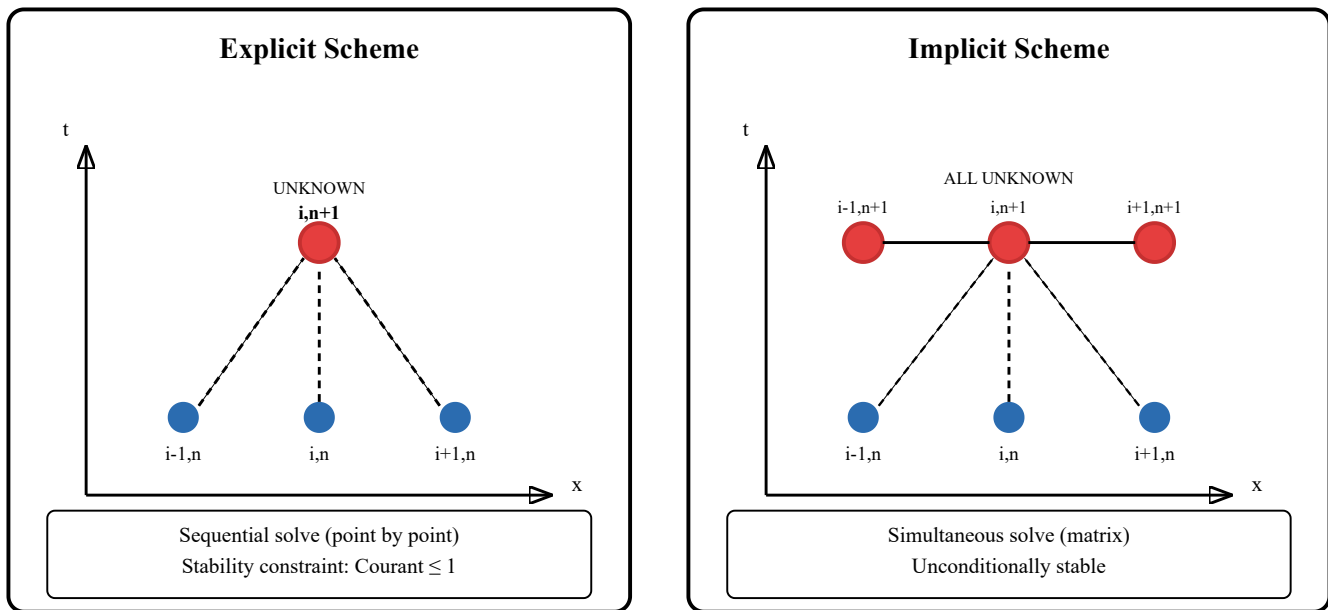


Figure: Comparison of Explicit and Implicit finite difference schemes

Explicit Scheme:

In an explicit scheme, the solution at the next time step ($t = n + 1$) is calculated solely from the known conditions at the current time step ($t = n$).

- The equations can be solved sequentially, point by point.
- Simpler to implement mathematically.
- Subject to stability constraints (e.g., Courant condition) which force the use of very small time steps.

Implicit Scheme:

In an implicit scheme, the solution at the next time step ($t = n + 1$) is formulated using conditions at both the current time step ($t = n$) and the unknown next time step ($t = n + 1$).

- Requires solving a system of algebraic equations simultaneously (often involving matrix inversions).
- Mathematically more complex.
- Unconditionally stable for most linear cases, allowing the use of much larger computation time steps.